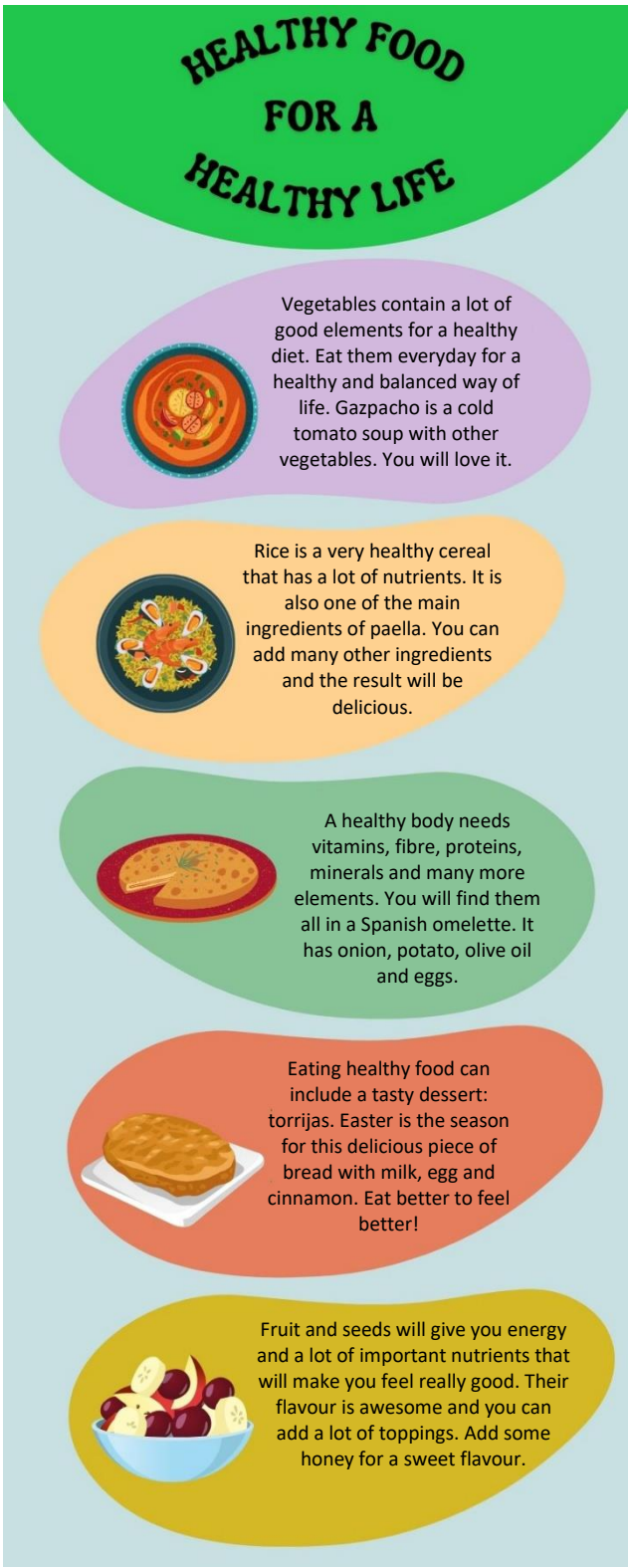
A2 - Written Mediation 3: Teacher's Notes

Before starting the mediation activity, ask students to read the task and the information carefully to make the aim of the activity clear.

You are what you eat.

Luke is a student from the USA who is coming to Spain for two weeks. He is on an exchange programme with his school and will stay with you. Luke and you have been exchanging e-mails every week to give information about yourselves and get to know each other better. Luke sent an e-mail last week saying that he is a bit worried about the food in Spain. He told you that he is afraid of trying new foods. He prefers pizza and hot dogs to fruit and vegetables. Luke thinks he will have a hard time because he will not like the food in a different country. Write an e-mail to Luke telling him about the benefits of a balanced diet and the importance of eating fruit and vegetables.



Your e-mail to Luke should be between 65 to 80 words. Remember that you have to use paragraphs and follow the structure of an informal e-mail.



In written mediation, you need to understand the texts and the images provided. When you understand all the ideas, try to explain your message in your own words.

Make sure it is clear why you are talking about the topic. Refer to the context.

Write a list of five nouns and five adjectives from the text that areimportant in order to understand the information given.

Let's get ready!

In this section, you will help students to get ready for the task. First of all, they will learn what to do (Analyse the task) and later, they will work on the information (Analyse the information). You can give them the Learning Sequence worksheet to work on.

1. Analyse the task

Tell students they are going to think about the receiver of the message, the reason for the message and the information included. This will help them to use the proper register (formal or informal).

a. Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

   a) Who will receive the e-mail? Luke

   b) Why are you going to send him an e-mail? Luke is worried about trying new foods.

   c) What is the main topic of the e-mail? healthy food and diet

b. After analysing the task, choose the correct answer.

   a) Being clear in the message *is* / *is not* important.

   b) You *need* / *don´t need* a lot of sentences and long messages to express your ideas.

   c) You *need* / *don´t need* to have clear ideas before starting to write.

2. Analyse the information

Tell students to think about the relevant information on the infographic they will have to use.

Read the information in the poster carefully.

   a) Which nutrients are mentioned in the text?
   proteins, vitamins, minerals and fibre

   b) Underline the main ideas you will use in the e-mail to Luke.
   Accept all logical answers.

Let's prepare the language!

In this section, students will learn structures and language suitable for the task.

1. Discuss advantages and benefits

1. Read this text written by a nutritionist. He is giving us information about what a healthy diet consists of and the benefits it has. Underline the names of the foods you find.

A healthy diet is very important. It can make you feel great and gives your body all the elements it needs. Fish, meat and eggs contain protein that will keep your muscles strong. A healthy diet helps your body to fight against infections.

Cereals, grains, nuts and seeds are a great way to include carbohydrates in your diet. They give you energy to do a lot of activities. If you feel tired after doing sport, eat some bread, biscuits or a cereal bar and you will soon feel better.

Fruit and vegetables are a very good source of vitamins, minerals and fibre. They contain a lot of water and will keep you hydrated.

Milk, yoghurt and cheese have got a lot of calcium. Including these foods in your diet, will make your bones and teeth stronger. It really makes a difference to your body.

Combine healthy ingredients and you will discover new flavours and new textures to enjoy every meal, every day!

Other Useful Language

Take care.
Best wishes.
Regards.
Best regards.
I wish you the best.
All the best.

"QUICK TIPS"

Do not use the same expressions all the time. Always include new words and expressions in your vocabulary and you will become more fluent.

2. Complete the following chart with the types of food below. Put them in the correct category.

chicken lettuce ice cream beef mushrooms apple cheese banana

MEAT	FRUIT	VEGETABLES	DAIRY
chicken	apple	lettuce	Ice cream
beef	banana	mushroom	cheese

2. Give reasons and examples

a) Four nutrients that a healthy body needs are vitamins, proteins, minerals and fibre.

b) One way of feeling better is eating healthy foods.

Let's mediate!

Make sure the students understand the task and you can summarise the tips below.

Luke is a student from the USA who is coming to Spain for two weeks. He is on an exchange programme with his school and will stay with you. Luke and you have been exchanging e-mails every week to give information about yourselves and get to know each other better. Luke sent an e-mail last week saying that he is a bit worried about the food in Spain. He told you that he is afraid of trying new foods. He prefers pizza and hot dogs to fruit and vegetables. Luke thinks he will have a hard time because he will not like the food in a different country. Write an e-mail to Luke telling him about the benefits of a balanced diet and the importance of eating fruit and vegetables.

1. Content

Content

Look at the poster on page 1 and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell Luke. You can use the following questions:

- Write the names of the cooked foods you can find in the text.
  gazpacho, paella, Spanish omelette and torrijas
- What ingredient can make fruit sweeter?
  honey

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your register to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.

Refer students to the task again and tell them to pay special attention to the Quick Tip. Make sure that the students read the rubric, so that they know what is important.

Let's evaluate!

Rubrics for assessment

Written Mediation

	Excellent	Good	Acceptable	Unsuitable
Clarity	The information is clear and easy to follow.The main points are emphasised.	The information is clear to follow but sometimes it is not easy to understand what the main points are.	The information selected is not relevant, lacks coherence and may include contradictions.	The information selected is not relevant, not clear, not easy to follow and includes contradictions.
Relevancy and processing	The student has summarised and paraphrased the main ideas without copying literally. No information has been added.	The student has summarised the main ideas but has not paraphrased them. No information has been added.	The student conveys some appropriate information by summarising the main ideas, but not all.	The student doesn't convey much appropriate information or has copied it from the text. Extra information may have been added.
Genre and organisation	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type, addressing it appropriately to the specific audience.	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type, but it is not addressed appropriately to the specific audience.	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type to a certain extent but the degree of formality is not correct.	The text does not follow the conventions of the specific text type, or it is not addressed appropriately to the specific audience.
Cohesion and organisation	The written text is logically organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs, which have a key sentence. A wide range of connectors and linkers is used.	The written text is logically organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs, which mostly have a key sentence. Basic connectors and linkers are correctly used.	The written text is organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs but they do not have key sentences. A few basic connectors and linkers are correctly used.	The written text is not logically organised. Some parts are not coherent. Paragraphs seem to have no connection. Some basic connectors and linkers are used but not all correctly.
Vocabulary	The student uses a wide rage of appropriate vocabulary. Spelling is correct.	The student mostly uses appropriate and varied vocabulary. Spelling is correct.	The student uses appropriate vocabulary but it is not varied. There are some spelling mistakes but they do not impede comprehension.	The student doesn't use varied vocabulary or is not able to paraphrase. There are many spelling mistakes.
Grammar	The student uses a wide range of correct grammatical structures.	The student uses a wide range of grammatical structures but not always correctly.	The student uses basic but correct grammatical structures.	The student uses basic grammatical structures but not always correctly.